

TEST PARAMETERS	REMARKS
Layering and separation	These headphones have excellent instrument layering and ensure that you are getting a taste of every instrument present in your track with equal appeal. This translates to accurate mastering of each track in studio applications.
Vocals	The vocals, thanks to the boost in the lower end of the highs, are well represented in the most complicated tracks and have a brilliant presence overall.
Bass sharpness	If you are a bass-head, then skip out on these headphones. The bass response of these headphones is fairly neutral, and you get a decent bass presence. Just the right amount is needed to master your track and track instruments like bass guitars with accuracy in your tracks.
Metal instrument density	The metal instruments and sibilants in your tracks will also be emphasised and represented accurately. And, despite the boost in the highs, those susceptible to discomfort because of extra sibilance will not experience any discomfort.
Detail and positioning	The details and positioning of instruments and vocals on these headphones is also precise, with each instrument, even in complicated tracks like Around the World by Kings of Leon, being represented with pin-point accuracy and accurate positioning. I know a lot of gamers are looking at studio headphones for their setups, and if you are one, then you won't be disappointed by the performance of these headphones. You might not get the thump you would expect from a traditional gaming headphone, but these will hold their own in any game you throw at them.
Distortion	Even at the highest of volumes, there's absolutely no distortion in these headphones. They peak at around 102dB, but at those levels, you will not experience any harsh distortions in audio or drastic changes in sound signature.
Staging	The staging of these headphones is fairly intimate, given their closed-back design. However, when compared to offerings from competitors like Sennheiser, the sound stage of the MDR-M1 headphones is fairly wide and open.

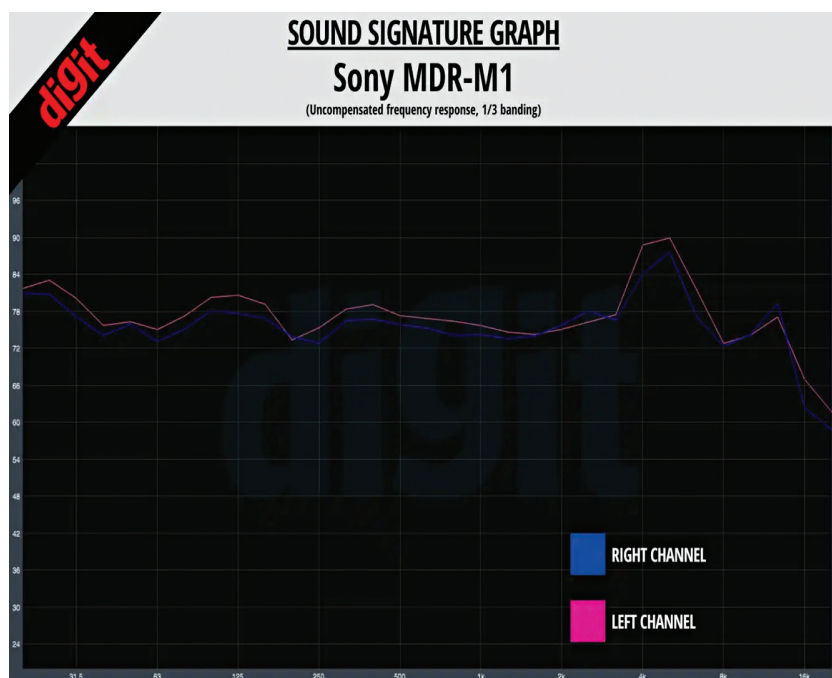
MDR-M1 headphones is – You will not be disappointed with what you get for your money. These headphones carry a steep price tag, which might

seem daunting for a lot of consumers in a price-sensitive market like India. However, if you take into account the use case of these headphones and the

pricing of other similarly capable offerings from other brands, you will not be disappointed with the value-for-money proposition of these headphones.

They have a great, neutral sound signature that is suitable for studio applications and a design and build that will not let you down in any which way. If you are looking for alternatives, though, and want something slightly more versatile than these headphones, then you can look at the Sennheiser HD 490 Pro headphones. They come with two pairs of earpads in the box, have an open-back design, and a similarly neutral sound signature.

–Satvik Pandey



SPECIFICATIONS

Driver Size: 40mm | Impedance: 24 ohms at 1 kHz | Frequency Response: 5 Hz to 80 kHz | Weight: Approx. 223 g | Sensitivities: 100 dB/mW

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